

IT Services - Payment Models Explained

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This document explains how we pay for our IT services and subscriptions, why each service uses its payment model, and what we get in return from each one.

Summary of All Services

Service	Payment Model	Purpose
Microsoft Azure	Pay-as-you-go (billed after 30 days of usage)	Cloud platform hosting our online services and resources.
Cloudflare	Annual (in advance)	Security, performance, and protection for our websites and online services.
DNS Filtering	Annual (in advance)	Blocks malicious and unwanted websites at the network level.
Web Hosting License	Annual (in advance)	Hosting for the 3CX phone system, including the SSL certificate.
SSL Certificate	Annual (in advance)	Encrypts connections so all data between users and our services is secure.
Grammarly	Annual subscription (per user)	Writing assistant for correct, professional English in emails, reports, and documents.
Lansweeper	Annual license	IT asset management - discovers and tracks all devices and software on our network.
Sanction Scanner	Annual subscription	Cloud-based AML tool - screens names against international sanctions and watchlists.
Claude.ai	Subscription (per user)	AI assistant for drafting, analysis, translation, and daily productivity tasks.
Domain Names (sos-palestine)	Annual renewal	Keeps ownership of our official domain names and protects our online identity.
Scalefusion (MDM)	Annual subscription (per device)	Mobile Device Management - secures and manages the organization's devices remotely.

Service	Payment Model	Purpose
Replit	Subscription (per user)	Cloud-based development platform for building, testing, and hosting applications and tools.

1. Microsoft Azure - Pay After Use (30 Days)

Azure is a cloud platform where we run online services (virtual machines, storage, backups, and other resources). Azure does not charge a fixed price.

- Consumption-based billing: we only pay for what we actually use (computing hours, storage space, data transfer, etc.).
- Billed in arrears: at the end of each billing cycle, Microsoft issues an invoice for the previous 30 days of usage.
- The amount can change from month to month depending on how much we used the services.
- Benefit: no money is paid in advance, and we never pay for capacity we did not use. If we scale down, the bill goes down.

2. Cloudflare - Annual Payment

Cloudflare sits in front of our websites and online services. We pay for it once per year, in advance, which gives us a discounted rate compared to monthly billing.

- Security: protection against DDoS attacks and malicious traffic before it reaches our servers.
- Web Application Firewall (WAF): blocks hacking attempts and common web attacks.
- Performance: content is cached and delivered from servers close to our users, so our sites load faster.
- Reliability: managed DNS and traffic routing keep our services available even under heavy load.

3. DNS Filtering - Annual Payment

DNS filtering is a security service that checks every website request from our network before it is allowed. It is licensed annually and paid in advance.

- Blocks access to malicious websites (phishing, malware, ransomware) before a connection is even made.
- Enforces company policy by blocking unwanted or inappropriate website categories.
- Protects all users and devices on the network, with reports showing what was blocked and why.

4. Web Hosting License - 3CX Phone System (Annual)

This is the hosting environment that runs our 3CX telephone system. The license is renewed once per year.

- Keeps our 3CX phone system (calls, extensions, voicemail, conferencing) online and available at all times.
- The hosting package includes the server resources needed to run the system reliably.
- Includes the SSL certificate, so all communication with the phone system is encrypted and secure.

5. SSL Certificate - Annual Renewal

SSL (Secure Sockets Layer) certificates encrypt the connection between users and our systems. Certificates are issued for a fixed period and must be renewed every year.

- Ensures all data (logins, calls, personal information) travels encrypted and cannot be intercepted.
- Shows the padlock and 'https' in the browser, so users and partners can trust our services.
- Without a valid certificate, browsers show security warnings and the services stop being trusted.

6. Grammarly - Annual Subscription

Grammarly is a writing assistant paid as a yearly subscription per user.

- Corrects grammar, spelling, and punctuation automatically in emails, reports, and documents.
- Improves clarity and tone so our official communication looks professional.
- Annual billing is cheaper than paying month by month.

7. Lansweeper - Annual License

Lansweeper is an IT asset management system licensed yearly.

- Automatically discovers every computer, server, and device connected to our network.
- Tracks installed software, licenses, and hardware details in one inventory.
- Helps us plan purchases, find security risks, and know exactly what equipment we own.

8. Sanction Scanner - Annual Subscription

Sanction Scanner is a cloud-based AML (Anti-Money Laundering) compliance tool, paid as a yearly subscription.

- Screens names of donors, partners, and suppliers against international sanctions lists and watchlists.
- Helps the organization meet compliance requirements and avoid dealing with sanctioned parties.
- Provides reports and an audit trail as proof of due diligence.

9. Claude.ai - Subscription

Claude.ai is an AI assistant paid as a subscription per user.

- Helps staff draft and improve documents, emails, and reports quickly.
- Supports translation, summarizing long documents, and analyzing data.
- Saves significant staff time on daily writing and research tasks.

10. Domain Names (sos-palestine) - Annual Renewal

Domain names are rented, not bought permanently. They must be renewed every year to remain ours.

- Keeps our official website addresses and email addresses working without interruption.
- Protects the organization's name online - if a domain expires, anyone could register it.
- Renewal is a small yearly cost compared to the damage of losing the domain.

11. Scalefusion (MDM) - Annual Subscription

Scalefusion is a Mobile Device Management (MDM) platform, licensed yearly per device.

- Lets the IT team manage, update, and configure the organization's phones and tablets remotely.
- Enforces security policies (passwords, encryption, approved apps) on every device.
- If a device is lost or stolen, it can be locked or wiped remotely to protect our data.

12. Replit - Subscription

Replit is a cloud-based development platform, paid as a subscription per user.

- Lets our team write, test, and run code directly in the browser, with no local setup needed.
- Used to build and host internal tools, scripts, and small applications quickly.
- Includes AI-assisted coding features that speed up development work.

Why the Payment Models Are Different

Azure usage changes constantly, so a pay-after-use model is the fairest: we are charged only for real consumption, measured over each 30-day period. All the other services (Cloudflare, DNS filtering, hosting, SSL, Grammarly, Lansweeper, Sanction Scanner, Claude.ai, domains, Scalefusion, and Replit) are fixed licenses or subscriptions that must remain active all year, so they are sold as recurring subscriptions — and where annual payment is available, paying yearly in advance costs less than paying month by month.